

Leadership in Action

An Interview with a Healthcare Manager

Interviewee: Abdullah Al Mahmood

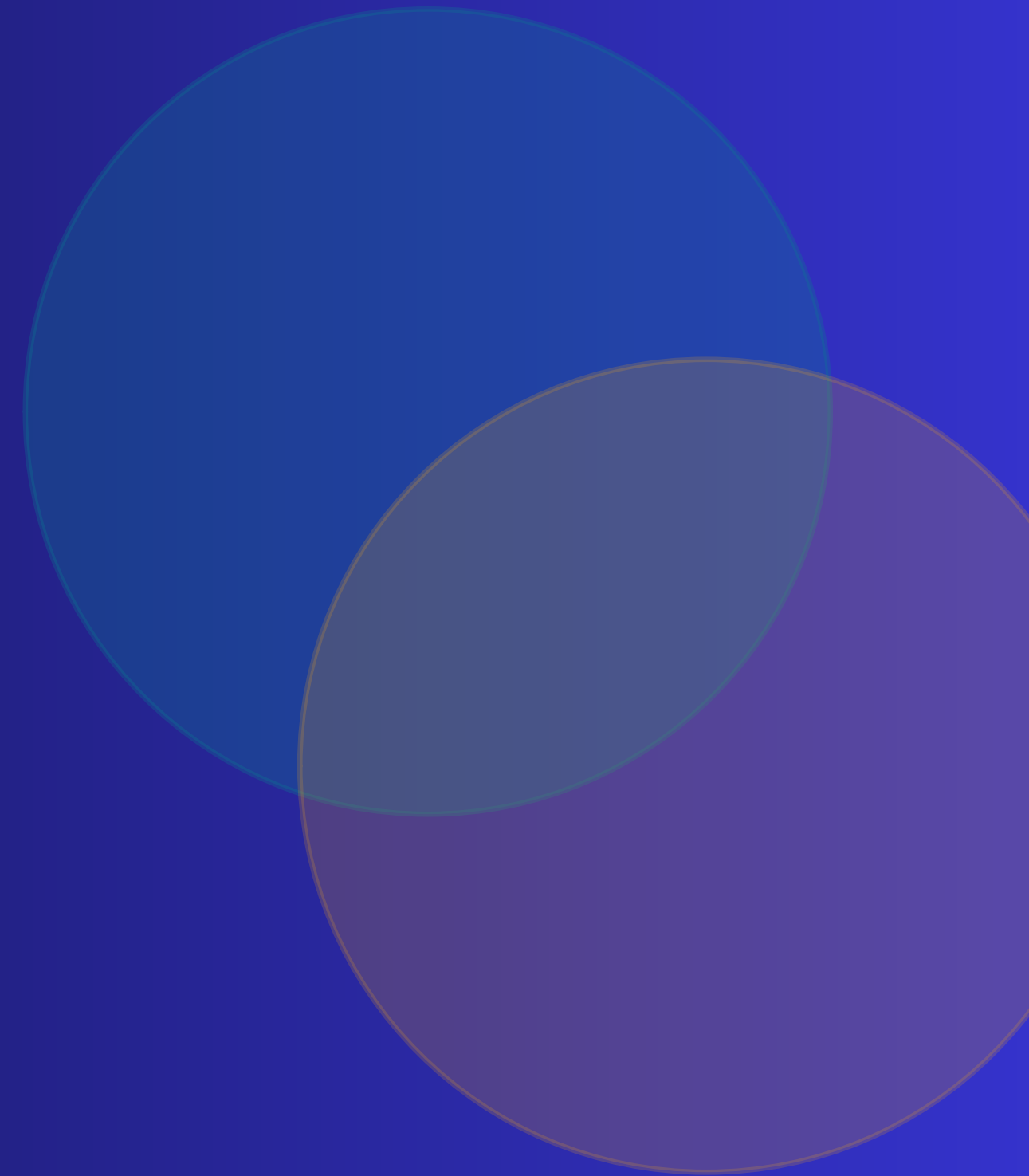
Position:

AGM & Head of Branch

Organization:

Popular Diagnostic Centre, Mirpur

Presented by: Kafee Bin Mahbub · Wasima Fahmida Oishi · Ahanf Jahin



About the Leader

26 Years

Experience at Popular Diagnostic

450+

Staff under his management

20 Dept.

Across two branch units

Career Journey



1999

Joined Popular Diagnostic Centre at Dhanmondi Branch



2001–10

Managed the English Road Branch for 10 years



2011–

Head of Mirpur Branch — now 14 years and counting



Today

AGM overseeing 450+ staff across 20 departments

Leadership Role & Responsibilities

"I have to look at four things: the machine, my technical person, my patient, and total management."

Patient Management

Overseeing patient flow from entry to report delivery; ensuring no step in the diagnostic chain is missed

Technical Oversight

Ensuring qualified phlebotomists, radiologists, and pathologists are in the right place at the right time

Machine & Quality Control

Keeping equipment operational and ensuring test accuracy — a wrong result can harm a patient's entire treatment

Team Coordination

Planning daily and advanced schedules; integrating all 20 departments through structured communication

Ethical Challenges in Healthcare Leadership

01

Zero Tolerance for Error

1,500–2,000 patients daily. Even a 1% error rate means lives affected. A wrong cancer report devastates a family — that 1 case is 100% to them.

02

Undue Pressure & Priority Requests

Patients and external parties often push for unethical priority. He must assess in 'a nanosecond' whether it is a genuine need or undue advantage.

03

Financial Integrity

In a cash-based system, he avoids any financial handling that creates suspicion. He requests a second person for all procurement — transparent by design.

04

Media Misinformation

Social media creates patient panic around medical reports. Neutralizing confusion and correcting misinformation is a daily management challenge.

Leadership Style & Management Practices

Digital Monitorin

CCTV cameras + 20 departmental WhatsApp groups + one consolidated management group — full visibility without micromanaging.

Crisis Management

Complaints are recorded, CCTV footage reviewed, and issues resolved in the same meeting cycle. "Whoever solves problems faster is the best."

Conflict Resolution

He investigates root causes directly — no reliance on hearsay or flattery — and avoids judgment based on personal favouritism.

Key Management Principles

1. Plan

2. Coordinate

3. Implement

4. Monitor

5. Solve Quickly

Key Lessons from the Interview

"Do not do duty — show responsibility. Duty keeps you in place; responsibility takes you forward."

1

Responsibility Over Duty

He distinguishes between doing a job description (duty) and genuinely owning outcomes. He checks locks, notices unclean floors, and responds beyond his assigned role.

2

Ethics Requires Courage

When asked whether unethical shortcuts are tempting, he said: 'I earn with merit, labor, and power.' He avoids any financial decision that creates even the suspicion of dishonesty.

3

Change is Survival

26 years in a private organization demanded continuous self-development. He says if he hadn't changed, he wouldn't have survived — adaptation is the leader's constant task.

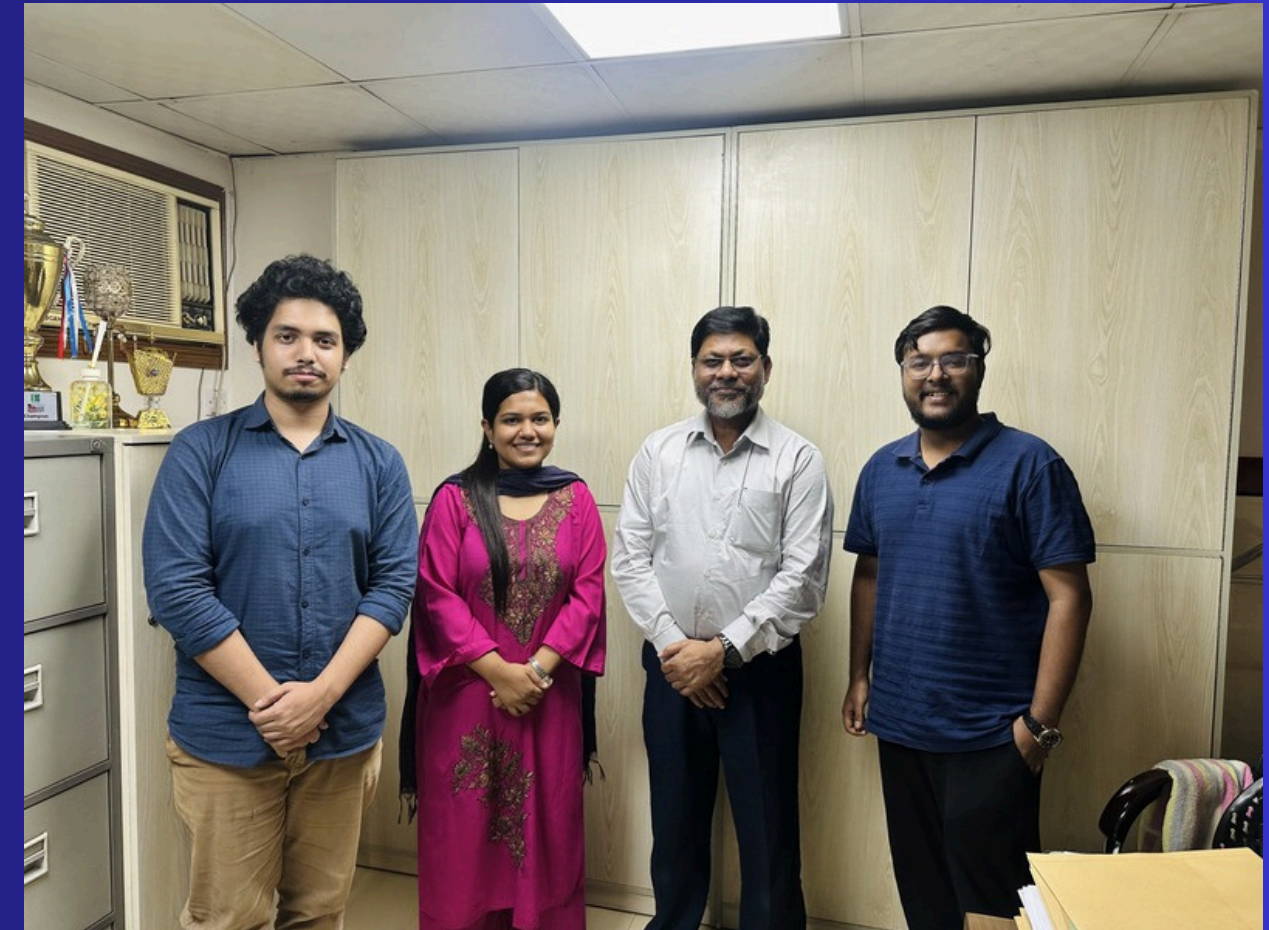
Conclusion

Abdullah Al Mahmud's 26-year journey at Popular Diagnostic Centre demonstrates that ethical leadership in a high-stakes environment is built on three pillars:

Precision — zero room for error when patient health is at stake

Integrity — refusing shortcuts, maintaining transparency, and resisting unethical pressure

Responsibility — going beyond one's job description to genuinely own outcomes



"Whoever can solve the problem faster is the best." — Abdullah Al Mahmud

Thank You